

Foreign Language Assistant

Foreign Language Assistants at Leigh Academies Trust play a pivotal role in the Modern Foreign Languages (MFL) department. They enrich students' learning by providing exposure to high-quality spoken and written language and fostering a deeper understanding of the culture of countries where the target language is spoken. They collaborate with teachers to deliver engaging and effective language education, inspiring students to develop strong communication skills and a passion for languages.

Core Purpose

The core purpose of the Foreign Language Assistant is to support the MFL teaching team in creating a dynamic and immersive language learning environment. This involves assisting with lesson preparation, delivering language activities, providing individual and small group support, and facilitating authentic language practice. The Foreign Language Assistant shares their cultural expertise, contributes to the development of resources, and supports the assessment of students' oral language skills. They promote intercultural awareness and global citizenship, enhancing the educational experience for both students and teachers.

Key Areas of Responsibility

1. Supporting Teaching and Learning

- Support teachers in the delivery of the MFL curriculum, assisting with lesson planning and preparation of resources.
- Prepare and deliver language activities and materials under the guidance of the teacher, adapting resources to meet the needs of different learners.
- Provide individual and small group support to students to improve their language skills, focusing on speaking, listening, reading, and writing.
- Facilitate authentic language practice through conversation, role-play, and discussions, encouraging students to communicate confidently in the target language.
- Share aspects of their own culture and experiences to enhance students' cultural understanding and promote intercultural awareness.
- Assist with the creation of resources for MFL lessons, including audio-visual materials and online content.
- Contribute to the assessment of students' oral language skills, providing feedback to teachers on student progress.
- Work with teachers in the classroom, providing support during lessons and activities.

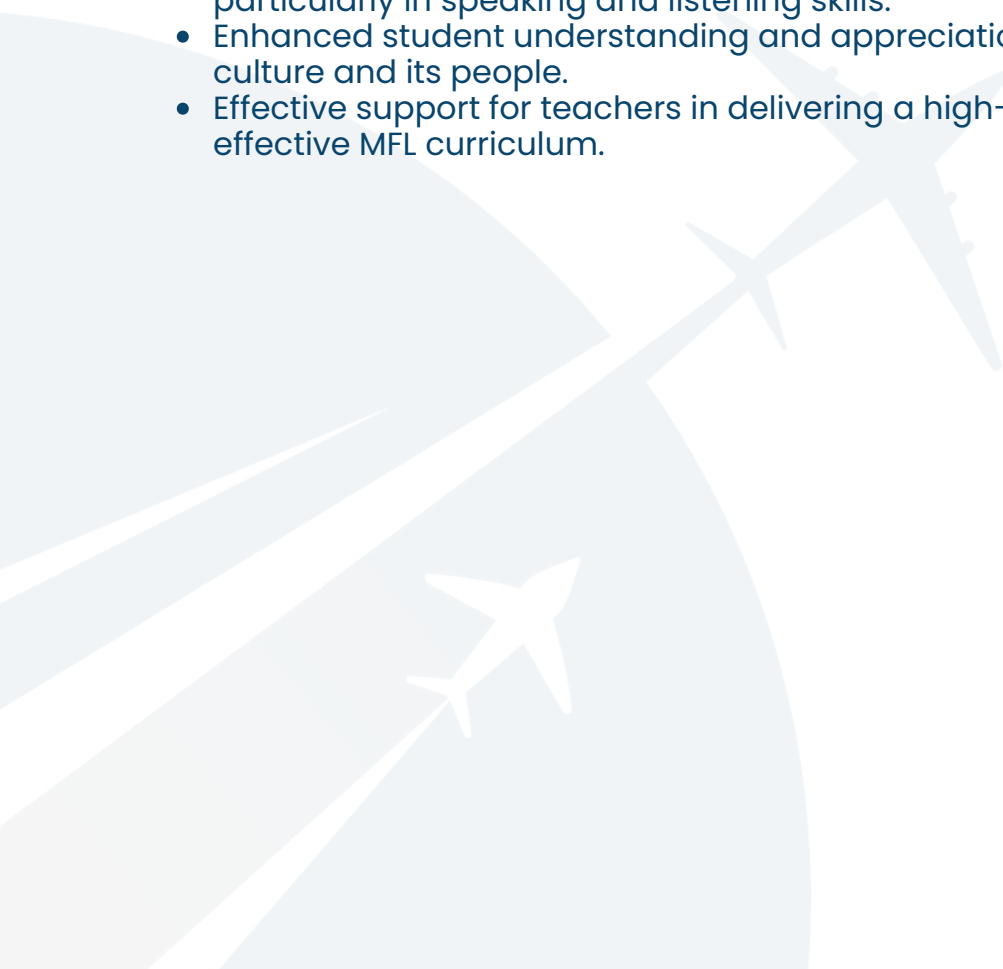
- Work independently with small groups of pupils, delivering targeted interventions or extension activities.
- Make recordings in their own language that the school can use as examples of native-speaker speech.
- Introduce and contribute to group discussions and role-plays in their own language.
- Work on specific topics with small groups of older students, providing advanced language support and cultural insights.
- Contribute to cross-curricular work in collaboration with other subject areas, promoting the use of languages across the curriculum.
- Help set up links with schools in their home country, fostering international partnerships and exchange opportunities.
- Contribute to international projects, providing linguistic and cultural support.

1. Wider Responsibilities

- Support all other departmental events as appropriate, such as language days, trips, and cultural celebrations.
- Liaise with other departments, outside agencies, etc., as and when required, and carry out such other work as may be appropriate to the role.
- Participate in activities and events as required by the Academies Development Plan.

3. Expected Outcomes

- Increased student engagement and motivation in MFL lessons.
- Improved student confidence and fluency in the target language, particularly in speaking and listening skills.
- Enhanced student understanding and appreciation of the target language culture and its people.
- Effective support for teachers in delivering a high-quality, engaging, and effective MFL curriculum.



Person Specification – Foreign Language Assistant

This section outlines the essential and desirable attributes for the Foreign Language Assistant role:

Qualifications and Training

Essential:

- Fluent/Native speaker of the target language, possessing a high level of linguistic competence and cultural understanding.

Desirable:

- Experience of working with young people, demonstrating an ability to engage and support students in a learning environment.
- A qualification in teaching or TEFL (Teaching English as a Foreign Language), providing a foundation in pedagogical principles and classroom practices.

Knowledge and Understanding

Essential:

- A good understanding of the culture of their home country, enabling them to provide authentic cultural insights and enrich students' learning.
- An awareness of the needs of students learning a foreign language, including the challenges and strategies involved in language acquisition.

Desirable:

- Knowledge of the UK education system, facilitating effective collaboration with teachers and a smoother integration into the school environment.

Experience

Essential:

- Experience of working in a school environment, providing familiarity with school routines, policies, and procedures.

Desirable:

- Experience of presenting to groups, demonstrating confidence and the ability to engage an audience in language learning activities.

Skills and Abilities

Essential:

- **Excellent communication skills**, both oral and written, in the target language, ensuring clear and effective communication with students and staff.
- **The ability to work effectively as part of a team**, collaborating with teachers and other colleagues to support the delivery of the MFL curriculum.
- **The ability to relate well to pupils of all ages**, adapting communication and teaching style to meet diverse needs and learning styles.
- **Good organisational skills**, enabling effective planning, preparation, and management of resources and activities.
- **Flexibility and adaptability**, with the ability to respond to changing priorities and work effectively in a dynamic school environment.

Desirable:

- **Competence in using IT**, including proficiency in relevant software and online tools to enhance language learning and create engaging resources.

Personal Qualities

The Foreign Language Assistant will be an **enthusiastic** and **engaging** individual with a genuine passion for **promoting language learning** and **cultural exchange**. They will possess a **positive and approachable manner**, creating a **supportive and encouraging atmosphere** for students to develop their language skills. Demonstrating a **professional approach** and **strong work ethic**, they will be committed to safeguarding and promoting the welfare of children. Furthermore, they will be **keen to contribute** to the wider life of the department and, ideally, have an interest in developing links between schools to foster international collaboration. They will also be **proactive in seeking opportunities** to develop their own skills and knowledge, **embracing feedback** and **striving for continuous improvement** in their practice.

Safeguarding of Students and Duty of Care

All staff, regardless of role, level of seniority and location, have a responsibility to ensure the highest levels of safeguarding and promoting the welfare of our pupils, and we expect all our staff and volunteers to share this commitment. We must collectively create an environment where children feel safe to learn, play, and grow. Children should feel comfortable in their surroundings and know that they can approach any responsible adult with any problems or concerns.

All staff must be able to identify any children who are at risk of harm, and know the characteristics of abuse or neglect. If you suspect or confirm harm then it's essential you know what actions to take.

Annual safeguarding training is offered to all staff at Leigh Academies Trust, and it is the staff member's responsibility to be aware of the most up to date guidance documented in the [Keeping Children Safe in Education document](#) (Department of Education).

Notes

The job description allocates duties and responsibilities but does not direct the particular amount of time to be spent on carrying them out and no part of it may be so construed. This job description is not necessarily a comprehensive definition of the post. It will be reviewed at least once a year and may be subject to modification or amendment at any time after consultation with the holder of the post.

The duties may be varied to meet the changing demands of the academy/business unit at the reasonable discretion of the Principal/Director. This job description does not form part of the contract of employment. It describes the way the post-holder is expected and required to perform and complete the particular duties as set out in the foregoing.